



Save video messages!

Skype now let's you save the video messages to play them later on Android:
<http://dgit.in/SkypeVdoSave>



Not cool Yahoo! Not cool

Yahoo reported to block users from accessing their mail if it detects an Adblocker installed
<http://dgit.in/YahooAdBlock>

tive does not have monetary goals, but unfortunately the same cannot be said for what Reliance stands to gain from it.

The European Solution

The Net Neutrality debate has been one with global implications. In recent times, most countries have either adopted regulations regarding the internet or are currently grappling with the same. The objective has been to achieve a solution that strikes a balance between user demands and the industry. The European Union seems to have achieved that with a Europe-wide net neutrality regulations standard.

will penalize any violation. Also, they have legalized the provision of better speeds to innovative services like IPTV or tele-surgery on the condition that they may come only on top of the existing free internet, not as a substitute. They must use the same internet protocols as the rest of the internet. This preferential position has to be objectively necessary for the service to operate, and it should not affect the free internet.

As ingenious and encompassing as the solution may seem, it doesn't really have a possible Indian counterpart at present. With the current stage of connectivity, the network congestion issue

The Unachievable Grey

We saw the differential pricing. We saw the free platforms. We had our debates and discussions on upholding and violating net neutrality. And then, along came a new concept: Data Refund.

The simplest and most accessible counterpart that can be provided to this is the cashbacks provided by online stores on the purchase of a certain product or of a certain amount. Take the example of Gigato, an android app, which rewards you with data balance for certain specific data usage. The rewards are app specific and are added to your account once the said data is consumed on that app, e.g. 10MB awarded to you for using 10MB of your mobile data on Whatsapp.

So does this violate net neutrality or not? That is more complicated a question than it appears. Although it does favour apps which can pay Gigato for the data reward, it does not set any restrictions on how that data can be used. So basically, you, as a user, are encouraged to spend more data in any way you see fit.

The way Gigato achieves this is by rewarding you a total data balance once you have achieved a certain total target MBs of rewards spread across a number of apps. This assures that they provide app downloads and usage to their partners, while providing free unregulated data to their users. A win-win for all.

The Data-vu

Interestingly, we came across Gigato in from two vectors recently. One was through an interview with their CEO (page 126) and next in a strongly worded letter drafted by the Save The Internet collective to Mark Zuckerberg after his IIT Delhi townhall address. It was cited as an example of how Facebook can realise its vision without creating barriers. What's interesting is that it made us at least mull over our stance on net neutrality (if not question it outright).

If properly analysed, the similarities between Gigato and Airtel Zero are unmistakable. What differs is only that the data is received in the form of a reward from Gigato, whereas by using Airtel Zero you save more of your data balance. An average person, without a zero rated



With less than 30% of the Indian population online, how much Net neutrality do we really need?

One of the most interesting parts of the rules they have adopted is the exceptions list to traffic management. They have set aside some situations where a network provider is allowed to perform actions like blocking, throttling, degradation or discrimination of data over the open internet. The situations are:

- If ordered by the law
- If threatened by cyber-attacks
- If network is temporarily congested

As small as they may seem, the above list of exceptions is actually exhaustive and they are well on their way to set up national level regulatory committees which

in India is a much more frequent phenomenon than the exceptions in the European model can allow. The services mentioned above which require better connectivity are not a primary need for the unconnected India in the near future. However, establishing a national level regulatory body for the Internet and issues pertaining to it might just give the regulatory aspect of India's internet some much needed direction. Until that is done, we at least need to try and think of some new concepts to tackle the increasing dilemma between our need for connectivity and our right to a neutral internet.